CP7 Checklist

Project / repo _____

Every stranger who meets a project — a potential contributor, a user, an employer — meets it through the same few files, in the same order: **What is this? Can I run it? May I use it? How do I help? What's it like here?** Check each item the way that stranger would, not the way you would. You already know everything, and they don't.

1 · README `README.md`

- [ ] The **first sentence** says what it is and who it's for
- [ ] A **status** line: what works today
- [ ] A **quickstart** that works, or an honest "not runnable yet" pointing to `docs/setup.md`
- [ ] Links to CONTRIBUTING; ends with a license line

2 · License `LICENSE`

- [ ] Exact license text; fields filled in **if it has any** (MIT, BSD: year and holder)
- [ ] A **one-paragraph rationale** recorded: why *this* license for *this* project, not MIT by reflex

3 · Contributing guide `CONTRIBUTING.md`

- [ ] Opens with **how to get started**, not with rules
- [ ] How to pick work, the PR process, review expectations (grown from your git standards); links to `docs/setup.md`
- [ ] Says what a newcomer should do **first**

4 · Code of conduct `CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md`

- [ ] **Adopted** from a standard (Contributor Covenant), not written from scratch
- [ ] A reporting contact you'll check, a response time, and a route for reports about you

5 · Templates + labels `.github/`

- [ ] **Bug template** asks for steps to reproduce, expected vs. actual, and environment
- [ ] **Feature template** asks for the need, the user, and today's workaround
- [ ] **PR template** checklist pulled from your git standards
- [ ] Labels: `bug`, `enhancement`, `good first issue`, plus your own, created **before** a form names them (a form skips missing labels)

6 · Setup placeholder `docs/setup.md`

The full guide comes once there's code to set up; a stranger follows it in the repo audit.

- [ ] The stack and prerequisites your design already commits to
- [ ] Says setup instructions arrive with the first runnable build
- [ ] Links the issue that tracks writing them

7 · Communication norms `docs/communication-norms.md`

- [ ] Where discussion happens
- [ ] Response times you can **actually keep** ("within a week," not "24/7")
- [ ] Who maintains, and how decisions get made
- [ ] How you'll know which new issues are **still waiting** for that reply (a label, a board column, a set day: your pick)

8 · Seed issues `Issues tab`

- [ ] 2–3 real next-work items, filed **through your own templates** (a task with no form? use the closest one, or add a task form)

✓ · Ship it `Canvas`

- [ ] Your review partner read your README and CONTRIBUTING **cold** on a Stranger's Read sheet, and you acted on it
- [ ] Everything merged to `main` through reviewed PRs (solo: a written self-review)
- [ ] A `cp7` tag pushed; its URL and a photo of the Stranger's Read sheet submitted in Canvas

> **Where the points are:** the two heaviest criteria are **Completeness** (everything above, substantive) and **Newcomer usability** (a stranger can tell what this is, where it's going, and how to start helping, from the docs alone), worth 25 each. The same stranger's test comes back in the repo audit, with install and run added.

Punch list for the build workshop — *what's missing or weak in your repo today, in the order you'll fix it*